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Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmillerriii@gmail.com>

Meeting summary

Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmillerriii@gmail.com>

Wed, Oct 25, 2023 at 3:15 PM

To: tatiana@nmschoolofmusic.com, lblind@nmschoolofmusic.com

Hi Tatiana and Larry,

After considerable thought I have decided to withdraw from teaching at the New Mexico School for schedule and business reasons. I am grateful to you for the opportunity I had with your students.

I remain committed to you as your piano technician and plan on resuming the Washington fall tunings tomorrow morning.

Thank you,
Chip

[Quoted text hidden]



Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Text Message from Larry and Email from Parent

Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmleriii@gmail.com> Tue, Nov 14, 2023 at 2:37 PM
To: lblind@nmschoolofmusic.com, Tatiana Vetrinskaya
<tatiana@nmschoolofmusic.com>

Larry Blind
(505) 980-3941



I can be there after 6 to fix the key entry problem. Can I tune early morning your pianos?

C

Oct 12, 4:03 PM

Sure, Kylie will help you with the keys. If I am in a lesson. Tomorrow morning should be fine. As long as you leave time to get down to southeast by 10:30. I'm not sure studio one pianos are the worst off though. That's for you to judge.

L

Larry Blind • Oct 12, 4:28 PM

Those tenths sounded pretty bad I will do a walkthrough

C

Oct 12, 4:47 PM

Chip, please do not contact any of your former students from our school by phone or email. This is not appropriate and I have received an email from a parent who was not very happy about your call.

L

Larry Blind • 12:57 PM

Larry,

I look to you to forward to me this email and publicly invite a meeting with the concerned parent to resolve any disputes or confusion. I will be holding you accountable for any failed communication that the School should have properly made during the course of my departure from the New Mexico School. Your failure to establish, or failure to attempt to openly establish, communication with the School, you as a representative, myself, and the parent will result in an open complaint of violation of the MTNA code of ethics, and the proper process will be followed.

I look forward to your reply no later than close of business today.

Chip



Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Text Message from Larry and Email from Parent

Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Tue, Nov 14, 2023 at 4:26 PM

To: Tatiana Vetrinskaya <tatiana@nmschoolofmusic.com>

Cc: Lawrence Blind <lblind@nmschoolofmusic.com>

Thank you Tatiana for jumping in, and please note that your response does not fill the request of my email, and if communication is not openly attempted by Larry as the recipient of the alleged email, or by you as his superior, between all parties for the purpose of clearing any misunderstandings, or if a copy of the alleged email is not forwarded to me by close of business today so that I may face my accusations and have an opportunity to clear the air of any misunderstandings, an ethics violation will be submitted. While I invite you to have a conversation with me to resolve this issue, your timely response and followthrough is appreciated.

On Tue, Nov 14, 2023, 3:04 PM Tatiana Vetrinskaya

<tatiana@nmschoolofmusic.com> wrote:

Hello Chip,

This message is to confirm that your last day of working as a piano teacher at the New Mexico School of Music was October 15, 2023. Once again, thank your for working with us.

Tatiana Vetrinskaya, Owner/Founder
New Mexico School of Music
505-573-5556

From: Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Sent: Tuesday, November 14, 2023 12:37 PM

To: Lawrence Blind <lblind@nmschoolofmusic.com>; Tatiana Vetrinskaya <tatiana@nmschoolofmusic.com>

Subject: Text Message from Larry and Email from Parent

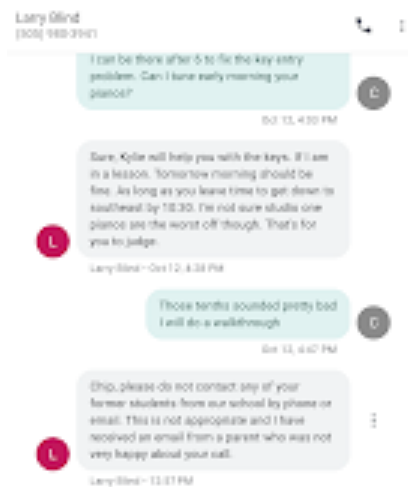
 Screenshot 2023-11-14 at 1.26.28 PM.png

Larry,

I look to you to forward to me this email and publicly invite a meeting with the concerned parent to resolve any disputes or confusion. I will be holding you accountable for any failed communication that the School should have properly made during the course of my departure from the New Mexico School. Your failure to establish, or failure to attempt to openly establish, communication with the School, you as a representative, myself, and the parent will result in an open complaint of violation of the MTNA code of ethics, and the proper process will be followed.

I look forward to your reply no later than close of business today.

Chip



Screenshot 2023-11-14 at 1.26.28 PM.png
227K



Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Text Message from Larry and Email from Parent

Tatiana Vetrinskaya <tatiana@nmschoolofmusic.com>

Tue, Nov 14, 2023 at
5:43 PM

To: "wgmleriii@gmail.com" <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Chip,

I want to let you know that, as the school owner, I am responsible for any concerns or issues our teachers or clients may express. From now on, please communicate with me directly. So far, I do not see any misunderstanding or ethical violation from our side. If you explain to me what is exactly your concern and/or disappointment, I might give you more clear answer.

Tatiana

From: Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Sent: Tuesday, November 14, 2023 2:26 PM

To: Tatiana Vetrinskaya <tatiana@nmschoolofmusic.com>

Cc: Lawrence Blind <lblind@nmschoolofmusic.com>

Subject: Re: Text Message from Larry and Email from Parent

[Quoted text hidden]



Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Text Message from Larry and Email from Parent

Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Tue, Nov 14, 2023 at 7:55 PM

To: Tatiana Vetrinskaya <tatiana@nmschoolofmusic.com>

I appreciate this so much. Thank you for communicating with me. Please know how grateful I am for this.

The ethical concern I have is in timeliness of communications to the parent regarding my leaving the school. There is now a problem, a parent is upset, I am in the middle, and I am either to blame, or the school's communication manner, or the parent. If I am to blame I will apologize to you and to Larry and to the parent. But if the communication problem and hurt parent is due to poor communication from the school there should be an apology from the school. It would be a trivial matter for a school to accept responsibility for a communication failure but could have a huge impact on me or you or Larry as an individual, should a parent be wondering about character. I did have a phone call to a parent at the parents request, so I do view Larry's reprimand as inappropriate and unless I am corrected, I would expect an apology from him. Tatiana I even asked Marcus this weekend if he would look after my former students. I left your business to pursue areas that you are not or do not intend on filling, or to teach in my own sporadic way, or teach online, or build a music theory program, (which I asked to build under you but you declined). I am not seeking to be in a hostile relationship with you, and your camaraderie and cooperation mean a great deal to me. I did experience an unusually poor level of communication from Larry, and the procedures for exiting a business were not followed according to standard business practices. I recognize that we are all pianists primarily and probably would prefer just to do that, but Tatiana I have lived in the business world for 15 years in IT, and saw many poor business practices, but the low level of communication I have seen from the school, and Larry's absolutely rude and unprofessional manner in his refusal to speak with me during the weekend, have caused my opinion of his work for you and for the community, your customers, to absolutely plummet. I wouldn't mind sharing this opinion directly with him.

Meanwhile we have a parent mad at me, or you, or both, or as I said perhaps the parent is to blame. A refusal to attempt to communicate is, to me, a refusal to admit the possibility of responsibility and make things right, and it leaves the door open for all parties to be held in permanent contempt. I see you communicating with me, and now I am requesting an opportunity for us both to communicate with the parent, and for willingness to be prepared to apologize and move on.

Please let me know your thoughts, maybe after you sleep on things. But time is precious in this matter I strongly believe. Can we continue this tomorrow, and plan on making a plan?

[Quoted text hidden]



Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmillerriii@gmail.com>

Text Message from Larry and Email from Parent

Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmillerriii@gmail.com>

Wed, Nov 15, 2023 at 4:34 PM

To: Tatiana Vetrinskaya <tatiana@nmschoolofmusic.com>

Tatiana, as Larry's supervisor I am notifying you that I have requested an apology from him regarding the text message delivered to me, and for his refusal to speak with me this weekend.

The communication problem with the parent should be responded to by noon on Friday at the very latest; anything longer than that, after receiving an email from an unhappy parent, to not have an apology or an invitation to an open conversation is unprofessional.

Please let me know your thoughts.

Chip

[Quoted text hidden]



Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Text Message from Larry and Email from Parent

Tatiana Vetrinskaya <tatiana@nmschoolofmusic.com>

Wed, Nov 15, 2023 at
4:56 PM

To: "wgmleriii@gmail.com" <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Chip,

I think I have already shared my thoughts about it in my previous email.

One more thing, please return the keys from the school building whenever you have a chance.

Thank you,

Tatiana Vetrinskaya

From: Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Sent: Wednesday, November 15, 2023 2:34 PM

To: Tatiana Vetrinskaya <tatiana@nmschoolofmusic.com>

[Quoted text hidden]

[Quoted text hidden]



Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Open communication request

Willis Glen Miller, III <wgmleriii@gmail.com>

Thu, Nov 16, 2023 at 5:52 AM

To: Tatiana Vetrinskaya <tatiana@nmschoolofmusic.com>, Toni Morgan <morgantonid@gmail.com>

Hello Toni and Tatiana,

In view of recent emails, and in view of the MTNA Code of Ethics, I request an open communication among us all to listen to and attempt to address any and all of Toni's concerns regarding the recent change of teachers. As teachers in the Music Teacher National Association we are given a Code of Ethics (https://www.mtna.org/MTNA/Explore_MTNA/Code_of_Ethics.aspx) which we strive to uphold, including

The teacher shall participate in the student's change of teachers with as much communication as possible between parties, while being sensitive to the privacy rights of the student and families.

Although we have been communicating via email, I offer and request a face-to-face meeting, the purpose of which is to understand all of Toni's concerns and clear the air of any misunderstandings or miscommunications, and make apologies or amends where needed so that we may all live in peace and harmony with each other. Due to the sensitive matters of families, education, and our own artistic temperaments, I also offer and request that the meeting be held in a geographically neutral place of Toni's suggestion, at a time agreeable to us all, and coordinated by a professional mediator.

Thank you for your time and consideration. In keeping with the above code, I will withdraw from sending any further emails to you until receiving your responses.

Chip

Willis Glen Miller III